Georg Hajdu

Sur|Valence

(2026)

for Broken Frame Syndicate (piccolo flute, Eb clarinet, viola, cello and contrabassoon)

Instructions:

Scordatura: all strings on the cello are to be tuned down by a major second.

The music is delivered in form of an interactive score on five pages. Each line consists of three images derived from individual photos captured by a camera monitoring car speed with decreasing abstraction from the original photo. There is a total of 30 lines. The pages are displayed a tablet computer where each image acts as a control element triggering (a) the movement of a cursor running across an image, (b) sound synthesis and/or (c) video playback.

Each page features a lead instrument. The first page emphasizes the contrabassoon, the second page the cello, the third page the viola, the fourth page the Eb clarinet and the last one the piccolo flute. The other instruments act as accompaniment to the lead instrument or pause. The performers decide on their own which actions to execute by pressing the images and when to proceed to the next page. Once they have advanced to the next page they cannot return to the previous one. The form emerges as the result of the interplay between performers who make their decisions spontaneously, whereby it is very likely that some choices made by one performer contradict the choices made the others. This friction is desired and should by no means circumvented by a defining a strategy prior to the performance.

Technical setup:

The piece requires a computer running a Max patch and five iPads or Android tablets connected to a local network, a four-channel sound system and video projection. Max requires the installation of MaxScore (computermusicnotation.com), Drawsocket (github.com/drawsocket) and odot (via the Max Package Manager)






























































































